giftly

we help *agents* find products you *love*.

THE MARKET

by 2030, agentic commerce is a *$3–5T* economy.

SHIPPED IN THE LAST 6 MONTHS

- ChatGPT Shopping
- Perplexity Shopping
- Amazon Rufus
- Walmart Sparky
- Gemini Shopping

THE RAILS ARE BUILT

- **ACP** Agentic Commerce Protocol
- **UCP** Universal Commerce Protocol
- **AP2** Agent Payments Protocol
- **MCP** Model Context Protocol
- **A2A** Agent-to-Agent

50M
ChatGPT shopping queries per day

1M+
Shopify merchants onboarding (Glossier, SKIMS, Spanx, Vuori)

10–20%
of purchases handled by agents by 2030

whoever owns the signal owns the next economy.

THE PROBLEM

agents can't tell the difference between a product that's *well marketed* and a product that's *actually great*.

- × advertising
- × SEO & GEO
- × reviews
- × paid placement

30%

of online reviews are fake — and rising with AI bot spam.

275M

fake reviews Amazon let through in 2024 despite $500M and 8,000 employees.

83%

of consumers don't trust AI shopping agents — and they're right not to.

we think the best products should win.

THE ANSWER

giftly is the ground truth for product quality.

the API every agent queries before they buy.

trygiftly.com

THE TRUST LAYER

the largest network of *human evaluators* on earth.

NETWORK		OUTPUT		CONSUMER
creators · experts · verified buyers	→	honest, structured product data	→	your shopping agent

every agent shopping with our data pays us.

today, our evaluators are *content creators*.

01 brands send creators free products

02 creators post only if they love them

03 creators earn affiliate commission on every sale

every match adds evaluation data to the long-term dataset.

in *1 week*, our network secured:

50

vetted creators

~2M

combined reach

7

official brand partnerships

$300M

combined partner valuation

WHAT WE NEED

$250k. 12-month runway. 3 technical founders.

BUCKETS

survival — *$108k*
3 founders × $36k × 12mo · SF cost-of-living minimum

GTM + scaling — *$112k*
see right →

legal / G&A — *$15k*
Clerky · contributor agreements · FTC compliance

reserve — *$15k*
tight on purpose

SCALING BLOCK ($112K)

brand acquisition — *$40k*
Smartlead + Apollo + Clay + 20 warmed sending accounts ($25k) · founder-led BD travel ($15k)

agent integration + trust study — *$55k*
LLM API for eval bench + matching ($45k) · integration tooling ($5k) · AI Engineer Summit + Anthropic event ($5k)

platform + verification — *$17k*
Supabase + Vercel + monitoring + domains ($7k) · contributor verification, fraud detection, identity attestation ($10k)

3 technical founders. founders build. capital pays for the network and the trust study.

THE BET

the future of agentic commerce will run on Giftly.

THE TRUST LAYER FOR AGENT COMMERCE

trygiftly.com

they've already *said* they won't.

> OPENAI ON INSTANT CHECKOUT
>
> *"product results are organic and unsponsored, ranked purely on relevance. merchant payments don't influence ChatGPT's product results."*

the moment they pick winners, they lose *neutrality* — and neutrality is the entire reason consumers trust agents to shop. they need an external source of ground truth. right now, they're scraping it from Wirecutter and Reddit — exactly the polluted data we started Giftly to replace.

we're not their competitor. we're the missing infrastructure.

wrong customer. wrong economics. wrong data.

wrong customer	Mercor sells to AI labs (RLHF for capability training). brand-side affiliate teams are a different buyer with different sales cycle, price point, and metric.
wrong economics	Mercor pays experts hourly. we get eval data as a byproduct of brand-funded creator commissions — zero labor cost to us. capital advantage flips.
wrong data	paid evaluators with no audience produce judgment without behavioral validation. that's structurally what gameable reviews already are.

the real threat is a commerce platform with brand relationships. but the trust layer has to be neutral — same conflict the labs have.

we don't come from attention economics. we come from *AI capabilities*.

ENGINEERING

Ethan Zhou

Berkeley · researcher at the Behavioral & Analytics Lab studying *how humans trust AI* to make decisions on their behalf — the core question of Giftly. *8 publications* (2 IEEE ML), patent pending.

"the right engineer to build the foundational dataset every shopping agent will run on."

RESEARCH + DESIGN

Armaan Priyadarshan

Dartmouth · AI capabilities + reasoning research. lead on *ARC-AGI-3* — the frontier benchmark for agent decisions under noisy, limited data. our system has beaten frontier LLMs and is closing on human baselines.

"Giftly is the same question at the scale of every product an agent will ever buy."

STRATEGY + COMMERCE

Samarjit Deshmukh

Dartmouth · debate national semifinalist, ranked *3rd of 16,000* senior year. 12 months daily research on AI × consumer commerce — data acquisition law, creator compensation, ecommerce disputes.

"the exact knowledge this entire company rests on."

Ethan and Armaan: best friends since high school — apps, an earmold manufacturing business. Armaan and Samarjit: 100+ nights in the CS basement, 12 projects, 3 hackathons in SF. last week we skipped school and moved into Ethan's dorm.

three phases. *12 months* to seed.

pre-PearX
NOW → JUL 2026

→ contributor network *50 → 5,000*, brand network *7 → 300* — all organic
→ ship v1 product: creator + brand portals, gifting workflow
→ first *MCP integration* live

PearX
JUL → OCT 2026

→ *3+ live agent integrations* with public case studies — ChatGPT App, Perplexity Plugin, Claude integration
→ *10,000+ contributors* (creators + expert evaluators), *500+ brands*, all organic
→ trust study preprinted on arXiv by Demo Day — "people trust agent recommendations more when those recommendations read Giftly signal"

post-Demo Day
OCT 2026 → JUL 2027

→ trust study peer-reviewed
→ *4+ agent surfaces* live with measurable share of recommendations
→ network compounds: *1,500+ brands*, expert evaluators across *15+ verticals*
→ seed round closed at *$5–8M*

APPENDIX · 05 — PMF

early *signals*, not yet PMF.

STAGE 1

wedge PMF

brand × creator marketplace works — CPA contracts close, commissions flow, both sides return.

→ early signals

STAGE 2

data PMF

eval dataset large + structured enough to answer interesting product-quality queries.

→ ~1k+ structured records

STAGE 3

agent PMF

agents query API in production. turning it off would visibly degrade their recommendations.

→ outreach in motion

DEFENSIBLE EARLY SIGNALS

- *0.67%* brand cold-conversion (7/1,043) · solid for B2B
- *Apollo Neuro* inbound CPA offer — willingness-to-pay, unprompted
- *$300M* partner-tier resonance in 1 week
- *1,043* brands in active outreach

LEADING INDICATORS WE'LL PROVE OUT

- first revshare check (closes unit-economic loop)
- first inbound brand inquiry
- creator-to-creator referrals
- first agent partner technical conversation

in active outreach: Firecrawl · Browserless · OneOff · doji · PayOS · Skyfire.